



Lockheed SR-71 Blackbird USA 1964

Horizontal stabilizer connects twin booms at their tails

Pilot tube to determine air speed

Designed to fly at more than three times the speed of sound

Rotating dish antenna detects other aircraft

OV-10 Bronco USA 1965

Boeing E-3 Sentry USA 1975

Boeing 707 airliner converted to carry an Airborne Warning and Control System (AWACS)

Tail-mounted pilot tube helps measure speed of drone

Turbofan engine gives top speed of 357 mph (575 km/h)

In 2001, a RQ-4 flew **nonstop** across the Pacific Ocean—a **first** for an unmanned drone.

Tailplanes mounted at the top of the tail

Northrop Grumman RQ-4 Global Hawk USA 2000

Nose cameras and infrared sensors to see at night

Advanced radar system builds 3-D picture of the ground below

Drone can fly itself or be remote controlled from the ground

Rear-facing propellers

Each wing has three hard points to which weapons can be fitted

BAE Systems Mantis UK 2009

and fly more than 1,400 miles (2,200 km). The **SR-71 Blackbird** was a dedicated spy plane that operated at high speed and altitude, out of the range of enemy ground-to-air missiles. No Blackbird was ever shot down by enemy forces. Advanced fighters feature stealth technology that

confuses enemy radars and other sensors, in order to spy undetected. Unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs), or drones, such as the **BAE Systems Mantis**, can fly long missions gathering information without risking pilots' lives. The Mantis can fly up to 30 hours.